

MD Kamrul Islam

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Marketing

College of Business, Illinois State University, Normal, Illinois, United States

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Consumer Behavior, Judgment and Decision-Making, Consumer Response to AI, Digital Platforms and Marketplaces

EDUCATION

College of Business, Illinois State University

May 2027 (expected)

Master of Business Administration (STEM), Business Analytics

Current GPA: 4.00 / 4.00

- Completed quantitative coursework spanning Programming for Data Science, Advanced Business Analytics, Advanced Marketing Analytics, and Applied Decision-making Tools.
- Pursuing two concurrent graduate certificates: Data Science (9 credit hours) and Business Analytics (12 credit hours), both expected May 2027.

Institute of Business Administration (IBA), University of Dhaka

Jan. 2018 — Jun. 2022

Bachelor of Business Administration, Marketing & Economics

Final Two-Year GPA: 3.65 / 4.00

- Recognized on the graduation Honors List for national-level achievements in Business case competitions.
- Completed foundational research and quantitative coursework including Research Methods, Econometrics, Business Statistics, Quantitative Analysis, and Consumer Behavior.

PUBLICATIONS AND WORKING PAPERS

Conference Proceeding

Islam, M. K., & Jagani, S. (2026). "Saying AI out loud: Cross-category evidence on how AI-signaling keywords shape post-purchase consumer evaluations." Proceedings of the *Decision Sciences Institute Annual Conference, San Francisco*.

- Examined how AI-signaling language embedded in e-commerce product listings shapes post-purchase star ratings, using the Amazon Reviews 2023 dataset across 3,869 products in two consumer electronics categories.
- Demonstrated that the effect of AI-signaling language is category-contingent and concentrated in the budget price tier, interpreted through expectation-disconfirmation and signal credibility theories.
- Introduced AI-signaling language as a new dimension of product listing signals within the emerging AI-and-marketing literature.

Working Paper

Islam, M. K., & Jagani, S. "Beyond the average effect: When AI claims improve and when they damage consumer evaluations" Targeting *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science*. [Archival analysis in progress]

- Extending the archival findings with additional consumer electronics categories to find the boundary conditions under which AI-signaling language helps product listing language.
- Developing two preregistered online experiments to establish causality and identify the psychological mechanism linking AI claim exposure to consumer evaluation.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Department of Marketing, Illinois State University

Normal, Illinois

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Aug. 2025 — Present

- Support instruction across multiple sections of undergraduate marketing courses, assisting faculty with course preparation, material development, and administrative coordination.
- Grade assignments and examinations against established rubrics, maintaining consistency and confidentiality across large sections.
- Courses assisted: MKT 440, MKT 350, MKT 345, MKT 230, BE 141

SELECTED PROJECTS

Peer Evaluation Automation System

Illinois State University

Designer and Developer (for MKT 350)

Spring 2026

- Replaced a manual paper-based peer evaluation process with a fully digital workflow covering student submission, scoring, and faculty review.
- Built a Google Form (dropdown inputs, ten Likert items, 100-point allocation) feeding a spreadsheet that automatically scores responses, flags self-versus-peer discrepancies, and checks submission completeness.
- Created a Looker Studio dashboard that refreshes every 15 minutes for team- and student-level review and documented a reusable semester rollover that reduces setup to roster updates alone.

AutoStock: Blockchain-Based Stock Market Automation

Dhaka, Bangladesh

Co-Author and Team Member, Team Masala Dosa

Sep. 2021

- Diagnosed structural inefficiencies in the Dhaka Stock Exchange, including settlement delays, intermediary fees, information asymmetry, and weak surveillance.
- Proposed a public permissioned blockchain architecture using smart contracts to automate trade execution, cash clearance, and settlement.
- Authored the supporting whitepaper, which earned the Silver Award (second nationally) at Blockchain Olympiad Bangladesh 2021 and a Merit Award at the International Blockchain Olympiad.

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Flagship

Dhaka, Bangladesh

Senior Marketing Associate

Nov. 2024 — May 2025

- Led product marketing for Horizon, an enterprise tool embedding short-form video into websites and apps, owning its go-to-market launch and website.
- Sustained a 25% click-through rate curating Horizon content on MyGP, Bangladesh's largest super-app.

Ilmiya

Minneapolis, Minnesota (Remote)

Marketing Team Lead

Jun. 2022 — Jan. 2025

- Directed marketing across product, engineering, and customer success for a K-12 LMS platform.
- Onboarded 14 schools in six months and lifted conversion rates 12% via restructured sales workflows.

Prottoy EdTech

Dhaka, Bangladesh

Chief Marketing Officer and Co-Founder

Aug. 2020 — Sep. 2022

- Co-founded Bangladesh's first visual learning mobile app (10,000+ users), leading all marketing and fundraising.
- Raised \$50K in seed funding and ran Mnemomania, a national Memory Olympiad engaging 113,000+ students.

AWARDS, GRANTS, AND HONORS

Merit-Based Conference Presentation Award, College of Business

2026

- Awarded \$1,000 for research travel funding to present accepted paper at the DSI 2026 Annual Conference.

Full Scholarship, TRUE Leadership Conference

2026

- Received a fully funded scholarship to attend the leadership development conference in North Carolina.

Graduate Honors List, Institute of Business Administration, University of Dhaka

2022

- Named on the graduation Honors List for national-level competitive achievement representing the institute.

Award of Merit, International Blockchain Olympiad — Global Final, Dhaka, Bangladesh

2021

Silver Award (Second Nationally), Blockchain Olympiad Bangladesh

2021

Award of Merit, International Blockchain Olympiad — Global Final, CityU, Hong Kong

2020

Fifth Place, Blockchain Olympiad Bangladesh

2020

LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

- President**, Graduate Business Birds, College of Business, Illinois State University 2026-27
- Led strategic planning, networking, events, and budget for the college's graduate business student organization.
- Research Team Member**, Faculty-led Project, Illinois State University 2025-26
- Screened and synthesized peer-reviewed literature on intellectual property instruction to support manuscript development.
- Cultural Secretary**, Bangladesh Student Association, Illinois State University 2025-26
- Organized cultural events for Bangladeshi students, while managing logistics and social media outreach.
- Session Administrator**, DSI Annual Pedagogy Conference Organizing Committee 2026
- Supported live session delivery and technical operations as a member of the conference organizing committee.

RESEARCH SKILLS AND TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Quantitative Methods: Archival data analysis; text-based keyword classification and coding; OLS regression; clustering analysis (hierarchical and partitional); ANOVA; descriptive statistics; data cleaning and preparation.

Programming: R (regression modeling, data manipulation, clustering, ggplot2 visualization); Python (data collection, text analysis, exploratory data analysis).

Analytics and Visualization: Looker Studio; Power BI; Microsoft Excel (advanced); ggplot2; Google Sheets.

AI Tools: Claude and Claude Code; ChatGPT; Google AI Studio; Gemini; Perplexity

Research Tools: Google Workspace (Forms, Sheets, Docs); GitHub; Microsoft Office Suite.

Domain Expertise: Consumer behavior in digital contexts; e-commerce and marketplace dynamics; EdTech platforms and market strategy; brand and product positioning.

Professional Skills: Cross-functional collaboration; team leadership; project management; stakeholder communication; instructional support and mentoring; confidential data handling.

STANDARDIZED TESTS AND LANGUAGES

- GRE General Test (2023):** Total 315 — Quantitative 162, Verbal 153, Analytical Writing 4.5.
- IELTS Academic (2023):** Overall 8.0 — Listening 8.5, Reading 9.0, Writing 7.0, Speaking 7.5.
- Languages:** Bengali (native); English (full professional proficiency).

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

- Graduate Certificate: Business Analytics**, Illinois State University In progress
- Graduate Certificate: Data Scientist**, Illinois State University In progress
- Introduction to Psychology**, Yale University (offered through Coursera) 2020

REFERENCES

Sandeep Jagani, PhD, Associate Professor and Assistant Chair, Department of Management
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